



SUBSPACE LATTICE

Command the Fleet. Control the Lattice.

FLEET TACTICS · SIGNAL WARFARE · SOVEREIGN SPACE

Every ship is a weapon.

Every signal redraws the battlefield.

THE BATTLE FOR THE LATTICE

You do not conquer space.

You make it yours.

Your fleet is small, and every move changes what it can see, where it can strike, and which systems still work. Push too far and your relay breaks. Hold back and the opposing net claims the sector. Victory belongs to the commander who turns position into pressure—and pressure into one decisive opening.

ESTABLISH THE SIGNAL

Keep your Escorts linked and project Sovereign Space from the Command Hub. Your Formation is your reach—and your lifeline.

TURN SPACE INTO A WEAPON

Catch enemy ships inside your net to Target Lock their systems. Shape firing lanes for Beams and leave gaps only you can exploit.

FORCE THE FINAL MOVE

Strike the enemy Hub—or integrate the sector until hiding is no longer possible. The lattice makes every stalemate temporary.

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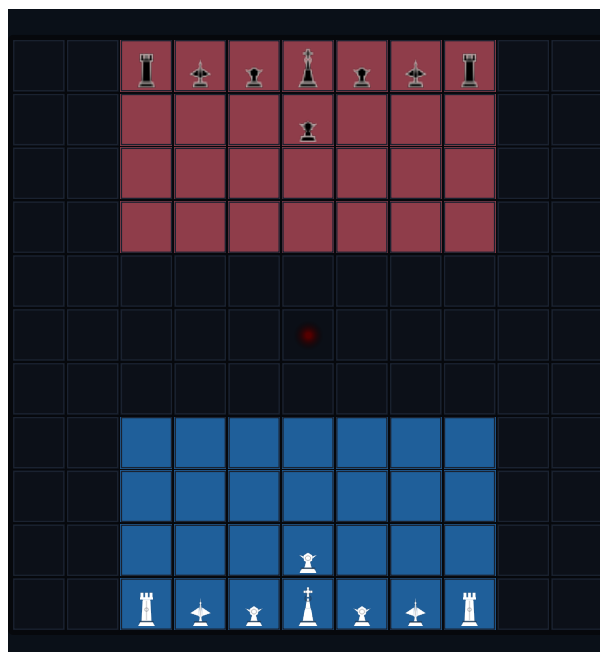
Official Player Manual

Every ship is a weapon. Every signal redraws the battlefield.

Subspace Lattice is a two-player tactical strategy game with no dice, no luck, and no fog of war. You command a small, specialized fleet of ships. Your goal is not just to destroy the enemy, but to project your Sensor Net across the board, claiming space until the opponent has nowhere left to run.

I. The Battlefield & Setup

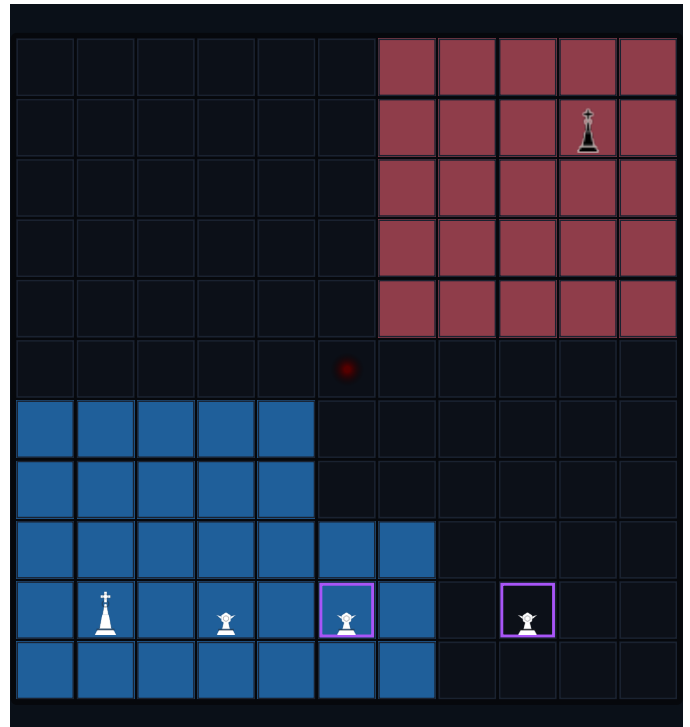
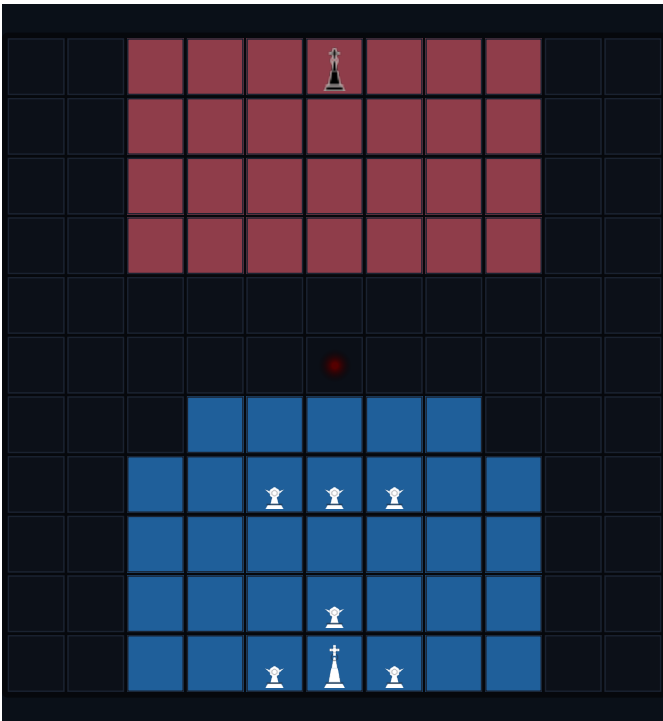
- » The game is played on an 11x11 sector grid.
- » The center square is a Gravity Well.
- » Pieces cannot occupy or move through the Gravity Well.
- » Each player starts with eight core pieces: 1 Command Hub, 3 Escorts, 2 Infiltrators, and 2 Beams.
- » White moves first.
- » To balance this advantage, White begins with one extra Escort placed forward, known as the Initiative Relay.
- » Players alternate turns, moving exactly one piece per turn.
- » You capture an enemy piece by landing on its square, which removes it from the board.



2. Sovereign Space (The Sensor Net)

Your fleet projects a living, visible territory called a Sensor Net (or Sovereign Space). Controlling this space is the key to winning.

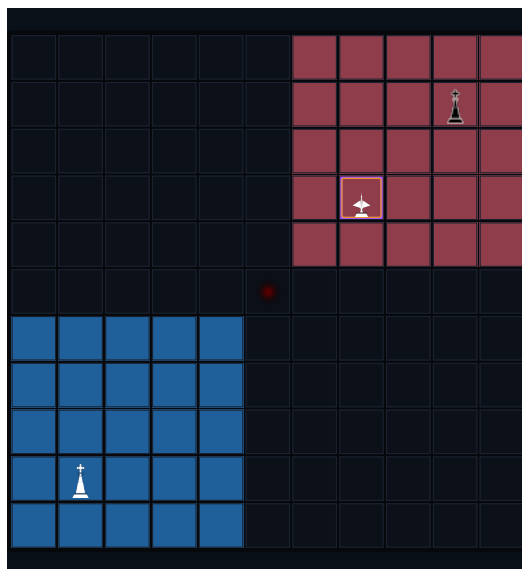
- » The Hub: Your Command Hub naturally radiates a 3-square zone of control in all directions.
- » Escort Links: Your Escorts can expand this net by radiating a 1-square zone, but only if they are linked to the Hub.
- » Forming Links: An Escort is “linked” if it is within 2 squares of the Hub, or if it connects to the Hub through a chain of other friendly Escorts spaced no more than 2 squares apart. Break the chain, and the forward Escorts stop projecting territory.
- » Contested Space: If both your Sensor Net and the enemy’s Sensor Net overlap on the same square, that space becomes Contested. Contested squares do not count toward either player’s territory clock.



3. Target Lock

Your Sensor Net is also a weapon. If an enemy piece ever sits inside your active Sensor Net, that piece becomes Target Locked.

- » A Target Locked piece is heavily crippled.
- » Regardless of what type of piece it is, a Target Locked piece loses its normal abilities and can only move exactly one step orthogonally (up, down, left, or right).



4. The Fleet

Unless a piece is Target Locked by the enemy, it moves according to these rules:

- » ♔ Command Hub: Your most vital piece. It moves one step in any of the eight directions. It projects subspace 3-grids in every direction.
 - ◇ After remaining still for a number of moves (default 15), a Command Overload EMP is armed. This charge is lost when the Hub moves or fires the EMP. EMP costs a full turn. Blast radius default 3. Only affects enemy fleet.
 - ◇ When the game reaches two lone Hubs, a countdown begins and after that time is reached (default 10 plies, both players) a Terminal Overclock EMP is armed which will permanently shutdown your ship and the enemy Hub if it is in range. Missing is an immediate Loss. Hitting is an immediate Win. The blast radius grows by a formula shown on the next page.
- » ♙ Escort: The backbone of your network. It moves one step orthogonally (up, down, left, or right).
- » ♖ Beam: Your heavy artillery. It slides in a straight orthogonal line as far as you want, similar to a rook in chess. However, its entire movement path—including its final destination—must remain strictly inside your own Sensor Net. It cannot slide through empty, un-net-worked space.

- »  Refractor: An optional, specialized dreadnought that exploits the diagonal subspace seams of your network (similar to a bishop in chess). Like the Beam, it requires an active telemetry link; its entire movement path and destination must remain strictly inside your Sensor Net. It cannot slide through the unmapped dark.
- »  Carrier: Optional, achieves omni-directional grid control (similar to a queen in chess), bound by the same strict Sensor Net law. However, this massive hull relies on a strict Hub-anchor. To execute a full slide, it must begin its turn drawing power from the Command Hub's 3-square radiation halo. Outside this tether, its capacitors starve, restricting it to crawling one step in any direction.
- »  Infiltrator: Your deep-strike specialist. It can warp directly to any empty square or enemy-occupied square on the board, jumping over other pieces. However, an Infiltrator cannot warp into a square covered by the enemy's Sensor Net.

Heavy wing is the lobby choice for which two “big” ships sit on your back rank at the start. It only swaps that pair (and where they sit). Hub, Escorts, Infiltrators stay the same.

Preset	Fleet	Files	Rated?
Standard Beams (default)	Two Beams (orthogonal, rook-like, only through your Sensor Net)	2 & 8	Yes
Refractor Wing	One Beam + one Refractor (diagonal slides, also net-bound)	3 & 7	Casual / unrated
Fleet Draft	One Refractor + one Carrier (Beam+Refractor movement)	3 & 7	Casual / unrated

Why files change:

Standard parks Beams on 2 & 8 so Infiltrators can sit on 3 & 7. The experimental wings put heavies on 3 & 7 instead, and Infiltrators shift to the vacated 2 & 8 files.

Fleet Draft's extra rule:

The Carrier is Hub-anchored. Full slides only if it starts the turn inside your Hub's radiation; outside that tether it only steps one square. That keeps the queen-like piece from roaming free while still feeling like a dreadnought near the flagship.

In short:

Standard = twin orthogonal artillery (shipping default).

Refractor Wing = add diagonals.

Fleet Draft = Refractor + tethered Carrier for a denser heavy midgame.

5. How to Win

There are three ways to claim victory in the lattice:

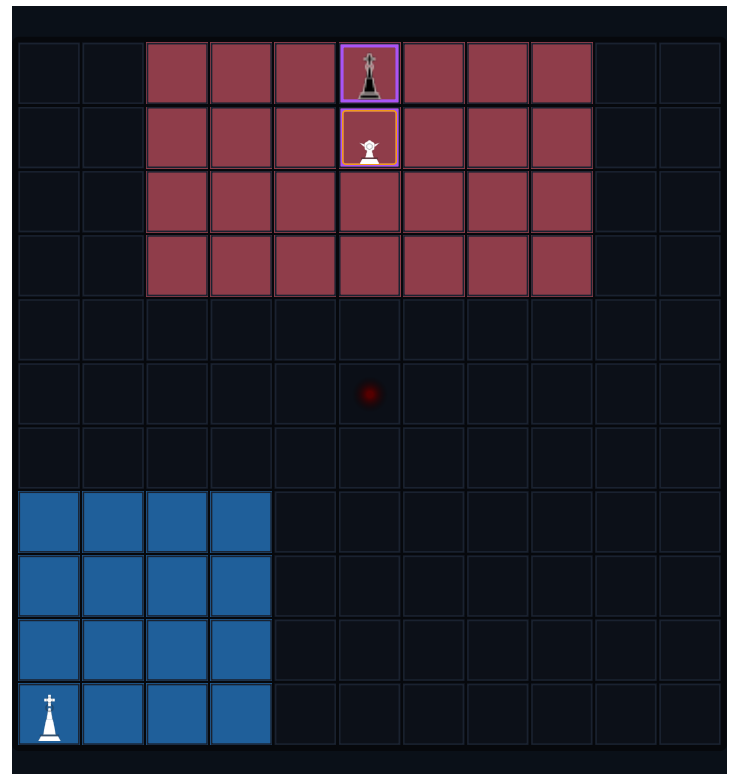
1. **Surgical Strike:** Capture the enemy Command Hub. The game ends immediately.
Your Hub is hanging if they can capture it next turn. The rules allow that; if they take it, you lose.
Refuse the hang → keep the Hub safe before other plans.
2. **Sector Integration:** Smother the opponent by expanding your territory. If your Sensor Net successfully covers 45% of the board's available space, you trigger the endgame clock. You must hold this 45% threshold for one complete turn without the opponent breaking your net. Note: This victory condition only becomes active after 100 total moves have been played.
3. **Lockout:** If you force your opponent into a position where they have no legal moves on their turn, you win. EMP is the practical path against a live Hub. See Academy Episode 11.

Command Overload (EMP)

- Charge on non-Hub moves while Hub stays put (default target 15)
 - Hub move or fire resets charge
- Fire = whole turn; radius default 3; enemy-only blackout (default 1 reply)
 - Your fleet isn't in the blast; cost is the spent turn

Terminal Overclock (EMP)

- Terminal Overclock countdown begins when both fleets are reduced to a lone Hub (default arms after 10 plies)
- Both Hubs share the counter
- Hub moves of either fleet do not reset charge
- Firing permanently disables own Hub, so missing the enemy is a Loss
- Blast radius grows by formula:
 $r = \min(10, 3 + [P / X])$
 - » r is blast radius
 - » P is plies since Terminal Overclock armed
 - » X is plies per +1 blast, default 5





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Play at lattice.iwgf.org · Rules & Academy in-app.